The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY · KEY NUMBERS · FROM THE INBOX · ON X · CYCLE TRACKER · EVENTS

SOX (Mon close)
11,083.47 +2.82% · MU $903.70 (+2.98%) · KOSPI (Tue close) 5,638.34 (+3.09%) · SK hynix ₩1,341,000 (+5.18%) · Samsung ₩222,000 (+4.23%)

DDR5 16Gb SPOT (TUE)
$61.33 flat · TrendForce 2026-10-27 11:00 GMT+8 · DDR4 16Gb $82.62 (flat) · NAND 512Gb TLC wafer $18.592 (Oct 19; page stale)

LEAD STORY

SUPPLY · LONG-TERM AGREEMENTS

Micron's Customers Are Already Negotiating 2031 Supply, Bank of America Says

After meetings with management, the bank says supply gets tighter in 2027–28 and multi-year deals cover about a third of sales. Chip stocks rebounded and Korea followed.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:55 IST Tuesday (UTC+2) · US closes from Monday · Korea/Japan Tuesday closes · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · US MONDAY CLOSES, KOREA/JAPAN TUESDAY CLOSES

MEMORY

Micron (Mon)	**$903.70 (+2.98%)**
Sandisk / WDC / Seagate (Mon)	**+1.42% / +3.63% / +2.18%**
SK hynix (Tue close)	**₩1,341,000 (+5.18%)**
Samsung (Tue close)	**₩222,000 (+4.23%)**
Kioxia (Tue close)	**¥12,605 (+0.44%)**
Won per dollar	**1,323.6**

PRICES AND WEEK AHEAD

DDR5 16Gb spot (Tue)	**$61.33 (flat)**
Q4 contract, JPM (DRAM / NAND)	**+13% / +18%**
Q4 contract, TrendForce (DRAM / NAND)	**+10–15% / +15–20%**
Seagate FQ1 guide (tonight)	**$4.10B ± $0.1B**
SKH Q3 OP consensus (Wed)	**₩76.96T**
WTI / US 10-year	**~$100.90 / 4.986%**

What this shows: memory stocks rose in New York on Monday and in Seoul on Tuesday. Spot DRAM was flat. Two forecasters put fourth-quarter contract prices up 10–20%, and the JPM and TrendForce figures agree. Korean and Japanese prices are Tuesday closes (15:30 local, 08:30 IST). Sources: Yahoo Finance, TrendForce, J.P. Morgan via X, Seagate, Korea Times.

Bank of America kept its Buy rating and $1,550 target on Micron after meetings with senior management. Analyst Vivek Arya says supply looks tighter in 2027–28. Customer agreements now run for several years, and talks on 2031 supply are under way. About 35% of sales are under such agreements, and the aim is 50% by 2030 (Investing.com, 24/7 Wall St). The note also says 1δ DRAM ramps in volume in the second half of 2027 and that buybacks step up from Dec. 9. Micron rose 2.98% to $903.70.

Chip stocks rebounded Monday as Anthropic's IPO filing revived the AI trade: the SOX gained 2.82%, and Western Digital (+3.63%), Seagate (+2.18%) and Sandisk (+1.42%) followed (CNBC). J.P. Morgan, via @pequityresearch, sees fourth-quarter contract prices up 13% for DRAM and 18% for NAND, in line with TrendForce. Spot was flat. In Seoul, KOSPI closed up 3.09% Tuesday after a buy sidecar at 10:13 KST, as foreigners turned net buyers after Monday's lowest close since April 6 (Hankyung, Seoul Economic Daily).

Our call: late upcycle, tight through 2027, unchanged. A touch firmer on how long agreements last and on packaging tightness, while the rally rests on fragile positioning. CYCLE SIGNAL: LTAS LENGTHEN

KOREA · SHAREHOLDER RETURNS

SK Hynix Jumps 5% as Investors Await Wednesday's Payout Plan

SK hynix will announce steps to raise shareholder returns with its third-quarter results on Wednesday (Reuters). The earnings call is at 09:00 KST, or 02:00 IST. Reports run from a ₩16 trillion (about $12 billion) special dividend funded by the Kioxia gain (Dong-A Ilbo, as reported by Bloomberg and Reuters) to $38–45 billion of extra returns (Seoul Economic Daily, via @jukan05). REPORT · NOT DECIDED The company says nothing has been decided and the plan needs board approval (Chosun Biz, Edaily). Consensus for the quarter is ₩98.23 trillion of revenue and ₩76.96 trillion of operating profit. Samsung reports Thursday (preliminary operating profit ₩107.4 trillion). SK hynix closed Tuesday up 5.18% at ₩1,341,000 and SK Square up 7.67%. EARNINGS WED · RETURNS

HBM · PACKAGING

Nvidia Lowers Vera Rubin's HBM4 Bandwidth 13% to Ease Supply

Nvidia's Vera Rubin datasheet now lists HBM4 bandwidth per GPU at 19.2 TB/s instead of 22 TB/s, and the NVL72 rack at 1,400 TB/s instead of 1,580 TB/s. HBM capacity stays at 288GB (ETNews). That implies about 9.4–9.6 Gbps per pin instead of about 11.7, which lowers the bar for yields and qualification at all three suppliers, which should help Micron and narrow the leader's premium. ZDNet Korea reports Samsung and SK hynix will ship 8-high HBM4 to Nvidia from about 2Q27. The bottleneck is moving downstream: REPORT TSMC is weighing CoWoS price rises of up to 20% (Commercial Times via TrendForce; TSMC has not confirmed). Applied Materials said Monday it will lift its Besi stake to about 20% to work on hybrid bonding. MORE SUPPLY PER WAFER · PACKAGING TIGHT

STORAGE · LABOR

Seagate Opens the Storage Prints Tonight as Micron's Taiwan Union Returns to Talks

Seagate reports fiscal first-quarter results after the US close (22:00 IST), with the call at 23:00 IST. Guidance is $4.10 billion ± $0.1 billion and EPS $7.30 ± $0.20 (consensus ~$4.14 billion / $7.42). Sandisk follows Thursday (guide $10.3–10.8 billion, 83–85% gross margin). Micron's Taoyuan union meets management Tuesday. No outcome had been reported by 08:20 IST. Members rejected the bonus plan 1,633 to 1,637; the strike mandate from Oct. 7 is still in force (CNA, Straits Times). HDD TEST · LABOR

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE OCT 26, 08:15 IST

NEW **Samsung could return ₩110 trillion.** Jefferies estimates Samsung's total shareholder return at ₩110 trillion, ₩80 trillion beyond the ₩30 trillion already confirmed, and sees another ₩40 trillion as achievable at SK hynix. ABF substrate lead times are 48–56 weeks, against 12 normally (TrendForce, cited). Jefferies Asia TMT

NEW **Price targets cut on multiples, not estimates.** Cantor trimmed SK hynix ADR, Seagate and Sandisk targets on lower multiples and kept them as top picks. It sees Seagate's LTA allocations running into 1Q CY28 and Sandisk's gross margin near 85.6%, above its 83–85% guide. Cantor Tech Weekly

The washout is still incomplete. Semis positioning is +0.8 standard deviations, and only 22% of semis and hardware names are oversold. KLA sees DRAM greenfield spending and ~100bp of gross-margin headwind from memory prices. Jefferies daily

ON X · SINCE LAST EDITION · IST

@pequityresearch · Oct 27 03:16
J.P. Morgan: Q4'26 DRAM contract pricing +13%, NAND +18%.
x.com/.../2114888812262211894

@jukan05 · Oct 27 03:51
Taiwan sell-side VR200 outlook: NVL72 racks 73k in 2026E and 96k in 2027E; SpaceX the largest 2027 buyer at 20k racks.
x.com/.../2114897732196573599

@jukan05 · Oct 26 10:58 UNCONFIRMED
Korean media: SK hynix preparing $38–45 billion of additional returns, mostly special dividends. The company says nothing is decided.
x.com/.../2114642724360163417

@dnystedt · Oct 27 01:47
Micron Taiwan's Taichung union deal: pay for 80% of workers rises to 2.7x; operators to NT$2 million+ from NT$630,000.
x.com/.../2114866507465494592

CYCLE TRACKER · UNCHANGED: FIRMER ON LTA LENGTH, POSITIONING FRAGILE

GAUGE	TODAY VS OCT 26 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	Q4 DRAM +13% / NAND +18% (JPM), in line with TrendForce +10–15% / +15–20%; 1Q27 call not out	**Slowing, still up**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $61.33, DDR4 16Gb $82.62, both flat while contract rises	**Flat**
Lead times / LTAs	Micron deals multi-year, 2031 talks, ~35% of sales toward 50% by 2030 (BofA); ABF 48–56 weeks; CoWoS +20% (report)	**Longer**
HBM content	Rubin HBM4 bandwidth 22 → 19.2 TB/s, capacity unchanged (ETNews); 8-high HBM4 from 2Q27 (ZDNet)	**Easier yields, fewer layers**
OEM cuts / de-spec	Galaxy A Q4 −20% (carry); no new cuts overnight	**Yellow flag holds**
Positioning	SOX +2.82%; KOSPI closed +3.09% Tue on foreign buying after the lowest close since Apr 6; washout incomplete (Jefferies)	**Relief, fragile**

How to read this: each row is a cycle gauge, with today's evidence and its direction since yesterday. Agreements got longer and packaging tighter; spot and consumer de-spec did not change, and the rally followed a sell-off, not fresh data.

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 20, OCT 26)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027, unchanged. A touch firmer on how long agreements last (BofA: Micron in talks on 2031 supply, multi-year deals ~35% of sales) and on packaging (CoWoS +20% reported, ABF 48–56 weeks). Nvidia's lower HBM4 speed bar eases supply. The Galaxy A yellow flag stands and the rebound is positioning-led. Seagate tonight and SK hynix Wednesday are the next tests.

EVENTS CALENDAR · OCT 27–NOV 3 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2)

Tue 27	Micron Taoyuan talks · Seagate FQ1 after US close 22:00 (call 23:00) · Knesset vote	HDD
Wed 28	SK hynix 3Q26 + returns (call 02:00) · FOMC 20:00 · KLA, MSFT, GOOGL after 22:00	HBM
Thu 29	Samsung call 03:00 · ECB · US GDP · Sandisk (22:30) · Intel, Amazon (23:00)	NAND
Fri 30	BoJ · Tokyo Electron · Kioxia H1 · CXMT Q3 by Oct 31	NAND
Sun Nov 1	Korea October exports · US clocks go back	Trade
Mon–Tue Nov 2–3	Apple FQ4 · Supermicro · AMD · US midterms Nov 3	AI

What this shows: dated events that could move the call; four memory and storage results land in three days.

The Memory Cycle Journal · independent research digest · not investment advice ·
Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #21 · Oct 27, 2026